Week 13

Recalling the week when we talked about the security cameras in Israel-Palestine, it makes me wonder to what extent a security fence is justified. On one side, the Israeli state is calling it a "temporary security measure" (Weizman, pg. 172). On the other side, this fence is clearly defining the territorial boundary between both states. The fence sharply delineates territorial boundaries, indirectly conveying the message that this land would remain under the control of the Israeli state. Something that I ask myself is this grand mission of controlling the land worth the lives of millions of citizens? Instead of a treaty to prevent massacres on both sides, they opt for this wall.

Personally, growing up next to the Mexican border, every time I cross the border to see my family, I have to go through this militarized border with 20 cameras looking at you from every angle. It knows the times you have crossed the border and the number of family members who have some sort of connection with you. Now, for the Palestinians who commute to work and home, going through the militarized checkpoints to see their family is a sense of taking away their humanity. Under the lens of the Israeli state, one cannot be trusted because all you are is a potential threat of being a terrorist.

I think when you see the growing number of settlements on Palestinian territory, it really makes you wonder if it's the citizens who are pushing this agenda or the Israeli political elite who push this chaos.

What steps or initiatives need to be taken to stop countless lives from being lost? There have been past historical conflicts such as North vs South Korea which are somewhat "resolved" but still remain conscious traditionalists. At what generation will this issue be disregarded amongst Palestinians and Israelis? Additionally, it is mentioned that Ma'ale Adumim is perfectly planned, where each house is a replica of the next. I've noticed especially in my home town, many of the new houses being developed also follow the same urban structure/development — is this politically intentional like the houses in Israel/Palestine?

Week 12

Erekat, Colonial Planning of my Grandfather's Hilltop

- Unable to explore and be with his land?
- California: Trespass warning
- Palestinians: Killed or detained
- Ma'ale Adumim: Perfectly planned, each house a replica of the next
    - Homogeneity is in direct contrast to Palestinian towns (add a bit of inconsistency to create irrational landscape)
- Israel's planning strategy: "everything must be systematically settled beforehand" - Theodor Herzl

    - Sharon and his team produced master plan that became known as The Sharon Plan
        - Political agenda + time constraint drove the development of the master plan
        - 1) Agglomeration of borrowed idea and models
        - 2) Plan answered the urgent need of providing fast housing for new Jewish immigrants especially to prevent the return of Palestinians refugees
        - 3) Divided Israel into a number of districts that were planned mathematically with modular neighborhoods to house an equal number of residents
        - Sharon Plan laid the foundation for the Israeli Apartheid state today
    - Enacted The Land Acquisition For Public Purpose Ordinance and the Absentee Property Law to legalize the confiscation of Palestinian land and limit Palestinians spatially
        - Urban and design guidelines aimed at attracting European Jewish settlers and displacing Palestinians
    - “Evacuation and building” == demolition of old Palestinian buildings, constructions of new streets, widening of the Jaffa Street in the heart of Jerusalem
    - Municipality produced design guidelines that catered to the immigrating Jewish population
        - Height limit, “modern” looking == red tiles, pitched roofs, green spaces → “planned community”
    - E-1 Plan: Expand Ma’ale Adumim from the west and connect it to Jerusalem
- Historicall processes of settlement and road construction leads to the deliberate creation of Greater Israeli Jerusalem
- Israel refuses to leave Ma’ale Adumim isolated, unconnected and within the Palestinian territories
    - Only way to be returned to its original owners is through a one state solution but no Israeli leader will voluntarily dismantle Ma’ale Adumim (symbol of colonial modernity, hegemony)

Week 10

Hosbey, Different Living

- Tidewater Virginia and the Mississippi Delta, particularly New Orleans to discover new possibilities of regional social and political affiliation outside of domination, extraction and violence
    - Share linked ecological and social history and fate

Week 9

Wollenberg, Berkeley: A City in History

- 2000: Berkeley city council approved formal landmark status for the Indian shellmound that once stood near the mouth of Strawberry Creek in West Berkeley
    - Mound filled with the debris and material remnants of the society that created it
- The Huichin
    - When the Europeans arrived in the late 18th century, Berkeley was inhabited by the Huichin
        - Lived in bands of a few hundred individuals inhabiting a well-defined hunting and gathering territory
        - No metals but manufactured variety of tools, implements, household goods (sophisticated baskets)
    - Hunted rabbits and small rodents, deer, elk, antelope, trout
    - Burned grasslands to promote the growth of edible plants and dug up meadows to harvest roots and tubers
    - Work of generations of Huichin women (grinding acorns and other seeds/nuts produced deep indentations in rock formations that are still visible in Mortar Rock Part in North Berkeley)
- Shellmounds created by people who may have preceded the Huichin by centuries were among the most dramatic of “imprints”
    - Examined layers of material deposited in the mounds → found a record of the evolution of Indian material culture over thousands of years
    - Significant transformations in tool making, diet, other cultural forms over the centuries but remarkable how little life seems to have changed
- Huichin achieved successful adaption to the environment and saw little reason for rapid change
    - Didn’t practice agriculture bc no need to
    - Huichin way of life emphasized continuity and tradition
    - Familiar with neighbors and participated in complex trading networks
    - Linked to the land by the most central elements of life, spirit and culture
- Spanish Colonialism
    - Beginning of the end of the Huichin way of life came when Captain Gaspar de Portola made the first European contact with San Francisco Bay in 1769
        - Ordered to establish settlements in California, looking for Monterey Bay but came to SF Bay instead
    - 1776: Captain Juan Bautista de Anza founded the first Spanish-speaking settlement on the bay
        - Spanish advance into California was an exercise in defensive expansion (attempt to prevent rival European colonial powers from occupying the area)
    - Spain sent very few Spanish-speaking people to a new colony such as California
        - Spanish came as ruling class, the colonial masters, and the work was done by the colonial subjects, the native peoples
    - For the Spanish colony to succeed, Indians had to be integrated into the new society as manual and agricultural workers

        - Mission was intended to Christianize the Indians and save their souls, but the Franciscan friars also disciplined and organized the Indians and taught them the skills, habits, and attitues of an effective colonial working class
        - Missions intended to destroy most of the Indian way of life, ended up unintentionally destroying most of the Indian people
    - Indians contracted European diseases where they had little to no immunity → death rate increased
- By 1820, seemed to have been no more native people left in Berkeley
- Spanish also brought the presidio/frontier fort to California
    - Each mission and pueblo (civilian town) had a detachment of soldiers to protect again Indian uprising and enforce the authority of the Franciscan friars
    - Most of the Spanish-speaking settlers in colonial Califoria were soldiers and their families
- Peralta family included Gabrel's seventeen year old son
- Peralta became an area that includes Oakland, Alameda, Piedmont, Emeryville. Albany, part of San Leandro, Berkeley
- Don Luis elected to live in San Jose + sent his four sons to occupy and operate Rancho San Antonio
- Peralta property was a typical California rancho in all but one respect: the original land grant was made during Spanish rule
- From 1821-1846, California was part of independent Mexico
- Decline and Fall of the Peraltas
    - Real change came as a result of the discovery of gold in the Sierra foothills in early 1848
    - No place was more transformed than San Francisco

De Certeau, Walking in the City

- World Trade Center is only the most monumental figure of Western urban development
- The "city" founded by utopian and urbanistic discourse is defined by the possibility of a threefold operation:
    - The production of its own space: rational organization must thus repress all the physical, mental and political pollutions that would compromise it
    - The substitution of a nowhen, or of a synchronic system, for the indeterminable and stubborn resistances offered by traditions: univocal scientific strategies, made possible by the flattening out of all the data in a plane project, must replace the tactics of users who take advantage of "opportunities" and who,
    - 3. finally, the creation of a *universal* and anonymous *subject* which is the city itself: it gradually becomes possible to attribute to it, as to its political model, Hobbes' State, all the functions and predicates that were previously scattered and assigned to many different real subjects—groups, associations, or individuals. "The city," like a proper name, thus provides a way of conceiving and constructing space on the basis of a finite number of stable, isolatable, and interconnected properties.

Week 8

Smarter Cities, Rio de Janeiro

- Beginning on 11/9, the SmarterCities Forumm in Rio de Janeiro was a unique event that brought 550 leaders of busiess, academia, and government from various cities across Latin America and the globe to discuss models to make cities smarter
- Why Rio?
    - City is undergoing major foundational transformations in preparation to host 2 mega events in the coming years (World Cup and Olympics)
    - Invested in smarter technologies and improved infrastructure that will transform its systems and improve the lives of its citizrns into the future
    - 4/25 largest cities in the world are in Latin America
        - Rapid growth across the region brings urgency to the need for investments in urban infrastructure to keep up with the local growth rate
    - To address issues that are common to the entire region, SmarterCities Rio foru brought forth best practices and pragmatic suggesstions for making city systems smarter in critical areas such as security, transportation energy and construction, etc
- Session I: A Planet of SmarterCities
    - Cities are the economic engines of sustainable growth for the 21st century
        - Creation of the Rio Command Center and the safety, securty, advance notice it offers to the citizens of Rio to help predict natural disasters
    - Sam Palmisano discussed the fundamental characteristics which will define a new breed of global urban leader
        - In order to build cities that drive global progress, leaders will need to be non-ideological – need to think in terms of systems of systerms and must manage for the long term
- Session II: The SmarterCities Agenda–Seizing the Opportunities
    - Global competition for funding, energy and talent is increasingly requiring leaders to do more with less
        - Explored how enerprising, forward-thinking mayors from some of Latin America's most rapidly growing cities have garnered support and addressed citizen cncerns to embark on serious urban transformation
        - Transformation of the role of the mayor in recent years + partnerships that are necessary to form with leaders of companies and federal government agencies in order to work toward progress and urban development
- Session III: The Smarter City — A System of Systems
    - Session explored urban subsystems and the ways in which they overlap, support and influence each other to improve the mechanical functioning of the city and its quality of life
    - Mobilization of private entities to help cities with limited government resources and the key considerations of civic leaders when entering into public-private partnerships
- Session IV: Investing in the SmarterCities Innovation Ecosystem

    - Governments are working closely with venture capitalists and entrepreneurs to drive economic growth
    - New investments in Smart Grid, renewable energy, government services, transportation and water management are fueling economic expansion and technological development
- Session V: How to Build a Smarter City
    - Cities are at the intersection of major global shifts
    - As the world's population becomes more urban, cernter of gravity of major challenge and opportunity is being shifted to cities
- Smarter Public Safety — Crime Prevention
    - First duty of any state is to protect its citizens and provide a safe environment for people to live and for businesses to thrive
        - How to achieve this in an urbanized world that has become mroe interconnected, fast-paced and unpredictable every day
    - Safety, security and low crime are crucial factors in determining overall quality of life
        - Smarter public safety is imperative for cities to succeed in global economy
- Smarter Public Safety — Emergency Management
    - Over past decade, world has witnessed a number of devastating natural disasters and terrorist incidents that created disruptions to cities and lives of citizens
    - New technologies are showing promise in helping cities improve emergency response measures
        - These can't ensure protection from large-scale urban threats
        - Being prepared == new guidelines for infrastructure projects, emergency response plans, government employee training, citizen awareness, tested methods of cross-organization collaboration
- Smarter Transportation
    - Congestion is a worldwide problem where transportation demand exceeds capacity
        - 10% reduction in congestion can lead to a 3% improvement in local GDP
    - City transportation managers must balance capacity needs while addressing: predicting demand and optimizing transportation infrastructure and assets, improving the end-to-end traveler and customer experience; improving operation efficiencies while reducing carbon emissions; and sustaining safety and security
        - To address, smarter cities must consider the multimodal transportation needs within the city and the movement between cities and countries
            - Requires integrating the transportation system
- Smarter Energy
    - Can improve the way power is generated, distributed, and used by adding digital intelligence to current systems
    - Using these systems, an energy company can address complex issues as: optimizing grid performance, preventing faults and outages, integrating more renewably generated wind and solar energy, restoring power faster after

disruptions, better supporting large-scale use of EVs, and helping consumers manage their energy usage

- Smarter Buildings
    - House critical city services and are connected to systems such as smart grid, water, transportation
    - Serve as symbols of modernity and progress
    - In a smart building, systems are not managed separately
        - Building harnesses nature

Friedman, The World Is Flat

- Berlin Wall was breached on 11/9/1989
- Secretary Baker was making his first visit to see crumbled monument to Soviet communism
- “This cement wall snaking across a modern city for the sole purpose of preventing the people on the other side from enjoying, even glimpsing, freedom”
    - Unleashed forces that ultimately liberated all the captive peoples of the Soviet Empire
    - Tipped the balance of power across the world toward those advocating democratic, consensual, free-market-oriented governance, and away from those advocating authoritarian rule with centrally planned economies
    - Cold War was a struggle between 2 economic systems (capitalism and communism) → fall of wall → one system left and people had to reorient themselves
    - More economies would be governed from the ground up by the interests, demands and aspirations of the people rather than from the top down by the interests of some narrow ruling clique
    - If not a democracy or a democratizing society/holdnig on highly regulated or centrally planned economics == wrong side of history
- Unwelcome: communism was good for making people equally poor
    - No better system than that
    - Capitalism made people unequally rich
- Tarun Das (unbiased)
    - Huge mass of regulation and controls and bureaucracy
    - Soviet Union was good: Allocate resources, give licenses, planning commission, etc
        - But they had a private sector – gave nation mistrust
    - India opened its economy
        - Trade controls abolished
- Fall of Berlin Wall didn’t just help flatten the alternatives to free-market capitalism and unlock enormous pent-up energies for hundreds of millions of people in places like India, Brazil, China, and the former Soviet Empire
    - Allows us to think about the world differently
- Berlin Wall was blocking sight and ability to think about the world as a a single market, ecosystem, community

- World became a better place to live in after 11/9, each outbreak of freedom stimulated another outbreak and process had a flattening effect across societies, strengthening those and weakening those above
    - Adoption of common standards (on how economies should be run, how accounting should be done, how banking should be conducted, etc)
    - Fall of wall enhanced the free movement of best practices
- Europe: Fall of wall opened the way for the formation of the EUropean Unions and its expansion from 15 to 25 countries
- No single cause for the fall of the wall
    - Termites ate away at the foundations of the Soviet Union (already weakened by the system's own internal contradictions and inefficiences)
    - Reagan administration's military buildup in Europe forced the Kremlin to bankrupt itself paying for warheads
    - Gorbachev's hapless efforts to reform something that was unreformable brought communism to an end
- Celebrating 11/9 but 9/11 was happening

Week 7

Levinson, The World the Box Made

- 1956: China was not the world's workshop
- Before the container, transporting goods was expensive
    - Value of it lies in how it is used
    - Highly automated system for moving goods from anywhere to anywhere with a minimum cost and complication
- Container made shipping cheap → changed the shape of the world economy
    - Ill-paid and ill-treated workers no longer existed
    - Maritime commerce cities disappeared
    - Ship lines were crushed by the cost of adapting to container shipping
- New economy was built
    - World ports
    - Small towns: cheap land and low wages to entice factories to enjoy cheap transportation
    - Industrial complexes developed because the cost of bringing raw materials in and sending finished goods out dropped
- Allowed firms to change ambition from domestic → international
- Multinational companies transformed themselves into internation manufacturers
    - Choose cheapest location to make an item
- Consumers have more choices thanks to trade
    - Increased living standards
- Low shipping costs == capital is more mobile
    - Increased bargaining power of employers against their less mobile workers
- High efficiency transportation but has become bad for customs inspectors and security officials

    - Hard to see what is inside the container
- In 1961 before containers were used, ocean freight costs accounted for 12% of the value of US exports and 10% of US imports
- Quicker handling, less time in storage == faster transit from manufacturer to customer

Cowen, Logistics Cities

- Basra Logistics City: one of the world's most violent and contested places in contemporary cartographies of warfare
    - Until January 2011, know as Camp Bucca (largest US military detention facility in occupied Iraq)
- Logistics City
    - Interrogates the old and new imperial logics that permeate the centers of circulations + explores the role of maps and plans in the production of logistics city space
    - Bucca was an imperial military facility
        - Extensive system of physical security
- Logistics is the most heavily privatized area of contemporary warfare
- "Basra Logistics City offers a secure, convenient and hassle free way for companies to set up and get to work in the booming Iraq market" - Jaffer
    - Could soon become a weighpoint on the new Silk Road
- Camp Bucca was at one point the largest US detention camp in Iraq and held 22,000 detainees despite capacity for 18,000
    - Home of some of the most serious and early accounts of detainee abuse + US military personnel
- Clark Air Force Base also transformed into corporate logistics facility
    - Was once the largest overseas US military facility in the world
    - Stronghold of combined Filipino and American forces during the end of WW2
    - Transformed into the Global Gateway Logistics City (GGLC)
    - Clark + Camp Bucca websites: offers "many state-of-the-art amenities, including controlled access with a comprehensive physical security system, a sound infrastructure capable of supporting the most sophisticated communication networks with inexpensive and stable power, along with good water and sewage treatment by virtue of the former U.S. Air Force base infrastructure"
- Dubai was the birth of the Logistics City
    - Establishes some precise precedents for the urban and global politics of labor, citizenship, and security at play in their deployment
    - Dubai Logistics City (DLC) was opened in 2007 as part of Dubai World Central (largest master-planned settlement on earth and the UAE)
    - "World's first truly integrated logistics platform with all transport modes, logistics and value added services"
- Emergence of the logistics city marks a fundamental transition in the global space economy wherein the design and management of supply chains has become so critical to just-in-time production and distribution that there is now an urban form named in its honor

    - Urban space is conceived for the singular purpose of securing the management and movement of globally bound stuff
- Dubai Logistics City set precedents for the production of urban space and the politics of infrastructure production
    - Prides itself for offering the “latest technology solutions” for transport, customer service, “security”
    - Vast majority of workers are on temporary work permits without any formal citizenship
- Interruption of flows becomes system vulnerability, and forces that interfere with flow are managed as security threats
    - Dubai’s geographic resolution to the problem of containing disruption and facilitating flow is now a model for port and infrastructure security in US cities
- Transportation Workers Identification Credential (TWIC) program can be understood as an attempt to institutionalize similar logics
    - Creates special “security zones” around ports where normal civil and labor law is suspended
    - Access to “secure areas” is controlled by biometrics and security clearances, organized through extensive new fencing, security gating, cameras, and other surveillance technologies
- 2012: World’s largest military port complex was set to become “a world-class trade and logistics center”
    - Led by ProLogis (world’s largest owner, manager, and developer of distribution facilities)
    - Oakland Global is one of the largest logistics facilities in the works in North America
- Tsawwassen is marketed as Canada’s first successful “modern urban land treaty”
- What is Logistics Cities
    - “City Logistics is the process for totally optimizing the logistics and transport activities by private companies in urban areas while considering the traffic environment, the traffic congestion and energy consumption” - Institute for City Logistics
    - City logistics is a response to a series of major geographic shifts
    - Will ensure a prosperous urban future
    - Leading city logistics researchers assert that “a city can be considered as a bottleneck where transportation resources are scarce relative to the potential demand and are thus highly valuable”
    - Fundamental idea is to “stop considering each shipment/company/vehicle individually” but “rather as components of an integrated logistics system”
    - Logistics cities and city logistics are 2 faces of the urbanization of global trade and battle space; they are the two prominent forms of urban revolution in logistics
    - Centrally important in the rise of the logistical city is the remaking of urban spatial form

    - DHL asserts that “the firm was not only a pioneer in international shipping, DHL Express was the first express carrier to service all US Department of Defense theaters worldwide”
        - “Constantly monitor world events to spot crisis situations that may impact your shipment
    - Violence of imperial trade isn’t new to the city and vice versa
- Plans play a powerful role in the making of urban space – render new political forms, concretizing something virtual and helpignt o constitute it as actual
- “The spatial distribution for sovereignty, discipline, and security is equally important but differently organized”
- LC is a reflection of the rise of logistics over the past few decades from a residual to a leading concern of business strategy and a part of institutionalizing logistics at the core of globalized production, trade and security
- Urbanism today must be understood as “metroloitanization” which “ comprises the emergence of multicentred assemblages predicated on interconnective technical systems”
- “Yet in this new logistical imperialism, the occupation of the city remains a question of not only which “citizens” (human, commodity, or corporate) occupy but whether indeed acts of urban citizenship can produce a city after occupation”

Week 4

Prashad, The Darker Nations

- After Columbus arrived on Jamaica in 1494, the Arawak population of 100,000 → handful
    - English colonial officials + plantation owners, enslaved Africans and indentured Indians
    - Independence only came in 1962
- New regime of Nelson Manley’s People’s National Party crafted a social development agenda to counter the chainless bondage of postcolonial life
    - Jamaincan governement pursued the policy of “industrialization by invitation”
    - Government relied on targeted direct foreign investment (bauxite sector)
    - Only return to Jamaica was because of taxes to the government, wages to the working class and a small tribute to the Jamaican managers at mines and plantations
- Manley-Lewis policy hoped to harness whatever domestic funds it could find + accumulate state revenues from the sale of bauxite
    - Jamaican economy grew at an annual rate of 7% on average, per capita income rose by almost 4.5%
    - Jamaica’s government leased its economic sovereignty to foreign capital → growth wasn’t sustained
    - Over 60% of the goods used in the country came from abroad (energy, consumer, food)

    - Lack of economic diversification + use of foreign investment for the repayment of loads instead of social development → increase in unemployment from ~10% in 1960 to ~25% by 1972
- Decline in trade → Called “competition state” by Susanne Soederberg
    - Each state competes with each other to provide the best conditions for private portfolio capital
        - Population can’t deliver sufficient taxes on its income and profits
    - 1974 formation of the Internation Bauxite Association (IBA)
        - Australia, Guinea, Guyana, Jamaica, Sierra Leone, Surinam, Yugoslavia
        - Combined power of the companies worked against the mutual competitions between states
        - Decline in commodity trade in early 1980s
            - Countries lost on average about 5% of their GDP, dampened state’s budgetary flexibility
    - Bauxite trade was hit hard by shifts in the use of aluminum
        - Sugar exports also declined bc First World market moved toward beet sugar and artificial sweeteners
    - Borrowing without the ability to pay back the loans + interest was the cause of the debt crisis for the Third World
        - “Emerging markets” → 1) “Fast-growing exporters of manufactures” 2) “New rich commodity exporters”

What Do We Mean When We Say, “Structural Racism”? By Walter Johnson

- Benjamin uses the phrase “presence of mind” to describe what he means: “Presence of mind is an extract of the future and precise awarenessof the present moment [that is] more decisive than foreknowledge of the most distant events”
    - Taking note of the fullness of the present, of both the structural imprint of the past on the present and the emergent tendency of the future
    - “Presence of mind” offers the righteous the chance to attempt to bend the present toward a better future
- Freedom is a principle of historical development: a theory of time
    - 1. US history is framed by a progression from slavery to freedom.
    - 2. History is a writ for US military action in Iraq; or, put more broadly,
    - the principles of historical development evident in the history of the United States
    - are universally applicable.
    - 3. Freedom is a political condition, defined by the achievement of political and civil
    - rights.
    - 4. African American history is the back-story of the history of American Freedom
    - Frames slavery as a prologue to the emergene of The Real American History out of the ashes of the Civil War

Given that the premise that race is socially constructed has become so generally accepted that even a well-trained Labrador retriever could be expected to assent to its terms, how is it that people in the United States continue to see the world in black and white—to imagine that there is something about racial difference that is more than skin deep? Race-thinking, they suggest in answer, is "an invisible ontology," a way of rationalizing the evident order of material reality—white privilege, Black disadvantage—by imagining that the explanation can be found at the level of natural rather than social history, by imagining that the historical ravages of racism can somehow be explained in reference to the underlying reality of race.[7]

- Why no "all men are created equal" → Because the Founders' saving fiction was the idea of racial difference
- Racial ideologies required constant verification in the material reality of everyday life
- Federal Housing Agency (FHA) raised the realtors' rule to a principle of governance by financing $120 billion of new housing in the US, less than 2% of which was available to nonwhite families

Lipsitz's notion of the "possessive investment in whiteness" helps us to see the temporal dimension of our material life. Single-family homes serve not simply as shelters, as containers for families, but as the means by which those families transmit wealth through time. And, as Lipsitz shows, this sort of real-estate time in the United States has always-already been racial time: it is preconditioned by the history of discrimination in the housing market, both public and private, and federal sponsorship of suburbanization and white flight.

These original exclusions are continually restaged in neighborhoods all over the United States when Black buyers manage to move in and whites immediately begin to move out. This process, too, is shaped by a sort of racial real-estate time or, really, a form of microeconomic racial capitalism, as individual whites try to preserve their largest capital investment, their houses, from what they take to be the value-threatening proximity of Black people. This process, which nets real estate brokers millions and millions of dollars each year, is not narrated or perhaps even understood as the result of the sort of red-letter racism of Bull Connor or George Wallace. It is instead understood as a rational response to objective reality: property values will go down; schools will suffer; my children will not be able to have the same sort of advantages I have had. It is an effort to ensure that the future unfolds properly from the present, that capital is carried forward and class privilege is reproduced over time. At its heart is a sort of white-supremacist hypostasis: a belief that "the market" will respond negatively to the presence of Black people. This belief can at once be individually disavowed—it is not that I

- While the federal subsidies to mostly white middle-class US homeowners have continued through the present day, notably in the form of the mortgage-interest tax deduction, the "possessive investment in whiteness" has taken an even more malignant shape in the era of the "War on Drugs." Discriminatory policing, selective enforcement, disparate rates of conviction, and wide variations in sentencing by race have combined in the creation of what Michelle Alexander has termed a new "caste" system in the United States: a vast class of incarcerated and disenfranchised Black men.[15] While African Americans account for 14 percent of the drug users in the United States, they constitute 35 percent of those arrested, 53 percent of those convicted, and 45 percent of those imprisoned for drug crimes.[16]
- Racial segregation in Saint Louis becan with the 1916 law establishing separate neighborhoods for Blacks and whites
    - Whites moved further out from the city
    - Midcentury Ferguson was defended by exclusionary zoning codes and whites-only collusion in the real estate market
        - Ferguson was known as a "sun-down" community: African Americans came to work in the day, out by night
        - In 2013, 86% of traffic stops involved Black motorists
            - Only 67% of population is Black and its roads are driven by a high number of white commuters
            - After being stopped, Blacks were twice as likely to be searched and arrested as were whites
        - City issued over 9,000 warrants for missed court appearances and unpaid fines
    - In 2013, city earned $2,635,400 from municipal court fines (second largest revenue share from a single source)
    - City has been farming Black population for revenue
- Department of Justice traced all this back to a lack of training, supervision, and oversight – clear racial bias
    - Historical amalgam of the "possessive investment in whiteness", corporate privilege, fiscal conservatism, misguided efforts to use "economic development" to promote social equality
- Under Hancock Amendment, municipalities can raise their sales tax without a local referendum in order to pay for the retirement of TIF bonds
- Murder of Michael Brown → international movement: outrage on Canfield Drive
    - F the Police, Black Lives Matter

> happened in Ferguson. What Poe calls the Michael Brown Rebellion may have begun with "Fuck the Police," but out of that confrontation on West Florissant it has grown and expanded to programs, solidarities, and aspirations greatly in excess of the police-focused solutions being proposed by the left-of-center mainstream: beyond the Reverend Al Sharpton's diagnoses of the problem as the actions of a few "bad-apple" cops who might spoil the whole bushel; beyond body cameras and civilian review boards; beyond even the much-needed investigation of the corrupt practices of the Ferguson police department (as well as of many of the other departments in Saint Louis County).[61]

- Ferguson Forward represents the notion that philanthropy and "talent identification" is a more appropriate form of corporate responsibility than paying taxes to support failing schools
    - Now a byword for police harassment and excessive force

Davis, Freedom is a Constant Struggle

- Since the rise of global capitalism and related ideologies associated with neoliberalism, it has become especially important to identify the dangers of individualism
- Progressive struggles are doomed to fail if they do not attempt to develop a consciousness of the insidious promotion of capitalist individualism
- Ten-Point Program of the Black Panther Party (BPP)
    - Obama's election was celebrated as a victory against racism but it wasn't
        - People who associated themselves with the movement didn't continue to wield that collective power as pressure that might have compelled Obama to move in more progressive directions
- Black feminism emerged as a theoretical and practical effort demonstrating that race, gender and class are inseparable in the social worlds we inhabit
    - Black women were asked to choose between the Black movement or the women's movement
        - This is the wrong question
- Global prison-industrial complex is continually expanded → profitability rising
    - Most profitable sector of the private priso business is composed of immigrant detention centers
- Society without prisons is a realistic future possibility but in a transformed society where people's needs constitute the driving force
    - Prison and its ideologies are deepy rooted in contemporary world
    - Imprisonment is used as a strategy of deflection of the underlying social problems
- Increase in people behind bars + increase profitability of holding them captive == destructive tendencies of global capitalism
- As struggles mature, produce new ideas and issues and terrains which must be engaged in the quest for freedom
- Ferguson reminds us that we have to globalize our thinking about these issues
    - Responses → organizations → continual movement
- To persuade people to think differently, consider abolishing imprisonment
    - People might come out worse

- Feminism doesn't belong to anyone in particular

Week 3

Prashad, The Darker Nations

- Wanted dignity above everything
- Cold War threateed the existence of humanity
    - Debates about poverty, inequality, freedom
- US used this to rebuild the two sides of Eurasian and cage in battered Soviet Union
- Darker nations amased as the Third World
    - Determined people struck out against colonialism to win their freedom
    - Demanded political equality on the world level
- Third World project included a demand for the redistribution of the world's resources, more dignified rate of return for the labor power of their people, shared acknowledgement of the heritage of science, technology and culture
    - "Let us remember that no blessing of God is so sweet as life and liberty"
    - "Highest purpose of man is the liberation of man from his bonds of fear, bonds of poverty, the liberation of man from the physical, spiritual and intellectual bonds which have for long stunted the development of humanity's majority"
    - Idea moved millions → created heroes
    - Flaw
        - Fight against the colonial and imperial forces enforced a unity among various political parties and across social classes
        - Working class and the peasantry in many moves led to an alliance with the landlords and emergent industrial elites
        - New nation → people believed that the new state would promote a socialist program
            - Instead, got combined the promise of equality with the maintenance of social hierarchy
    - By 1970s, new nations were no longer new, failures were legion
        - Popular demands for land, bread, and peace were ignored on behalf of the needs of the dominant classes
        - Dominant classes once ties to the Third World agenda now began to see themselves as elites instead of part of a project
        - Demise of Third World: people across the three continents continue to dream of something better, many organized into social movements or political parties

Holston, The Modernist City

- Brazil is already a population of builders
- Costa's narrative dehistoricized Brazil by mythologizing its first principles, government's planners paradoxically rehistoricized it